



Digit's Mobile Phone Wish List

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You might have noticed by now that we're great cribbers. With most of the products that we review, almost always, we can find either this element missing, or that other feature which could've been better. So we thought of coming up with our list of peeves. Better still, a wish list of what we would ideally want in a product. So here's a look at things we wish cell phones had, and maybe things even the industry at large should wake up and incorporate to make our lives easier. One thing is wishful thinking, but what is the reality? What are the latest developments taking place in the world towards perfection? We'll tell you about them too.

Universal charging

At some point in your life there would definitely have come a moment when you found yourself running around your office in sheer desperation looking for a Nokia *thin-pin* charger, or a Sony Ericsson W series charger. Isn't it frustrating? Your phone is about to die out, there's electricity around, but you can't tap into any of it! For long, people have been cribbing and crying about the thousand-odd types of charging pins out there, courtesy cell phone manufacturers trying to be unique perhaps. Why can't they just come together and make just one universal charging plug? It turns out they are. At the recent World Mobile Congress in Barcelona, the GSMA and 17 leading mobile operators and manufacturers announced that they are committed to implementing a cross-industry standard for a universal charger for new mobile phones. Apart from consumer experience improvement, the reasons are also energy saving and waste reduction. Hopefully, if all goes as per plan, you can expect the new charging solution based on Micro-USB to be the standard by 2012.

More battery. If not, then at least alternative charging methods.

GPRS, Bluetooth, Video, Music — all big time battery eaters. Some people resort to carrying spare batteries. Some carry car chargers. Could there be a better way? Well some time back we heard of motion-based chargers that utilise the human body's natural movements to create charge. So basically run around or go for a

walk to charge your phone. Such a device would create power by using motion-produced electromagnetic fields that are harvested, converted to electrical energy and stored. But researchers are scouting for still other ways. Companies like ZTE and Samsung showed off their earth friendly solar powered phones at WMC 09. While the ZTE is a rather plain looking 'making calls' type of phone, Samsung's Blue Earth is a full touch Eco friendly wonder. Imagine you're running out of battery. When this technology is perfected an hour in the sun and you should be good to go. But what about the fact that most people quite like to keep their phones in their pockets? Perhaps accessory makers could make hay while the sun shines by coming up with some strap-on devices! You could then perhaps even charge your phone while you're on your way to work.

More apps, more freedom, maybe fewer operating systems

Compatibility is a prickly issues when it comes to phones and the stuff you can run on them. Who has the patience these days really to look at which platform supports which application? Applications are very important. We would really like to see a free office suit on phones that allows more editing options. Restrictive operating systems inhibit innovation

and reaching the full potential of functionality of devices. Whatever operating system it may be, should allow independent developers to develop software applications. Otherwise you have people such as Apple who want to criminalise Jailbreaking, which allows users to circumvent the digital rights management (DRM) technology on the iPhone, to be able to install third-party applications not authorised by the company. Firefox incidentally is supporting the iPhone jail breakers.

Bigger Dispalys

Now that we have so much more to watch on our cell phones why do it on a itsy bitsy screen? When the iPhone came out it its large display, it made even the most hardened critics take notice and go "hmm that's nice". Now its about time someone came up with a bigger screen. Toshiba unveiled the TG01 which has a 4.1-inch 800x600 display, and a 1-

GHz CPU from Qualcomm. But we're greedier still. Bigger the better is always the way to go to get the most out of your portable media.

Better Cameras

Agreed phones have come a long way since the time of VGA cameras that produced grainy images that barely passed off as photographs. Still, when do you think they'll come close to truly replacing stand alone cameras? Lately many phones do have 5 MP and such. But that's not enough. The WMC saw a few phones like the Nokia N86 and Samsung Memoir which show that they're at least getting there, but a long way to go. Zooming is one area that requires improvement. Most cell phone cameras

